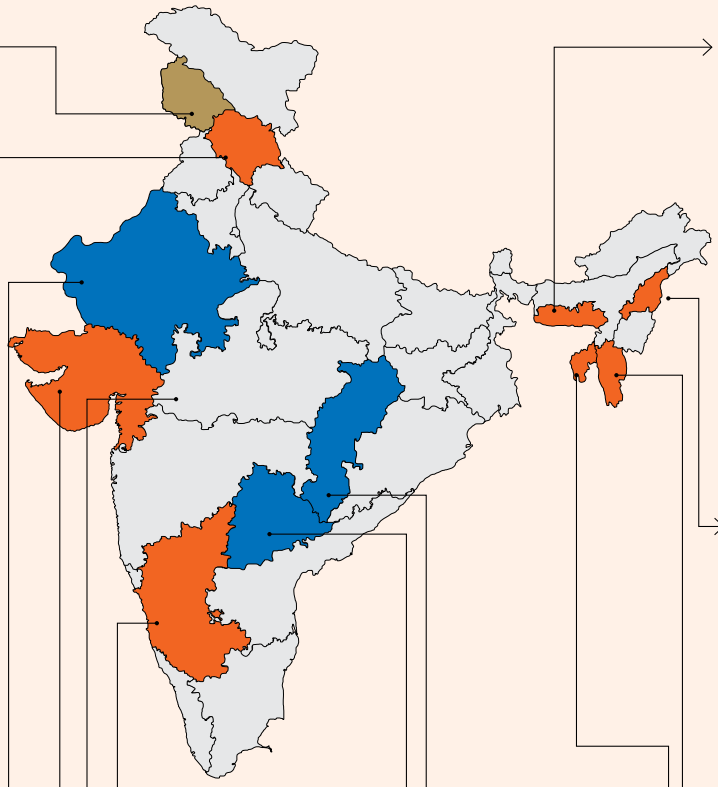
# BJP AND THE STATE POLLS IN 2022-'23



## JAMMU & KASHMIR

**ADVANTAGES**

● Hindu vote consolidation in Jammu ● Post-delimitation, BJP-led alliance may make headway in Kashmir ● Ghulam Nabi Azad's exit has weakened Congress; his new outfit may split opposition vote

**CHALLENGES**

● If Gupkar Alliance contests polls as a unit, it will consolidate opposition vote ● Anger among Kashmiri Muslims over abrogation of Art. 370

## HIMACHAL PRADESH

**ADVANTAGES**

● Relatively clean government ● PM Modi's appeal ● Hindutva has acceptance

**CHALLENGES**

● Congress regrouping under Pratibha Singh ● BJP regime faces anti-incumbency ● Factionalism in the BJP

## RAJASTHAN

**ADVANTAGES**

● Pro-Hindutva sentiment ● PM Modi's appeal ● Anti-incumbency against CM Ashok Gehlot and Congress ● BJP's tribal outreach, strong state organisation

**CHALLENGES**

● Indecision on ex-CM Vasundhara Raje's leadership ● State unit riven by factionalism ● Lack of an alternative to Vasundhara

## GUJARAT

**ADVANTAGES**

● Brand Modi ● Patels back with the BJP ● Party's outreach to Dalits, tribals ● New CM and cabinet have helped curb anti-incumbency

**CHALLENGES**

● Residual anti-incumbency after being in power for three decades ● Young voters tired of party, may want change ● KHAM (Kshatriya Adivasi, Harijan, Muslims) vote may back Congress

## KARNATAKA

**ADVANTAGES**

● Strong on-ground organisational structure ● Internal bickerings in Congress ● Pro-Hindutva sentiment ● Vokkaliga support base

**CHALLENGES**

● Deep inner party factionalism ● Corruption allegations, anti-incumbency ● Unhappy B.S. Yediyurappa family ● Lingayat seers looking at options beyond BJP

## MADHYA PRADESH

**ADVANTAGES**

● Hindutva ● PM Modi's appeal ● BJP's hold over the major OBC blocs

**CHALLENGES**

● Factionalism in BJP ● Too many Congress turncoats have been accommodated ● Weak government, corruption scandals

## CHHATTISGARH

**ADVANTAGES**

● Outreach to tribal community ● Anti-incumbency, corruption allegations against Congress regime

**CHALLENGES**

● Indecision on ex-CM Raman Singh's leadership and no clear alternative ● Party's inability to aggressively challenge the state government

## TELANGANA

**ADVANTAGES**

● PM Modi's appeal ● Outreach among OBCs ● Hyper-Hindutva narrative is working in urban centres

**CHALLENGES**

● Absence of a tested organisational structure ● Hindutva appeal limited to urban centres ● Opposition parties like Congress, TDP still big in rural parts of state

## MEGHALAYA

**ADVANTAGES**

● PM Modi's pro-Northeast image ● Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma's considerable hold in the state ● Congress meltdown

**CHALLENGES**

● Uneasy ties with ally and CM Conrad Sangma and his National People's Party ● TMC aggressively seeking space in state ● Inability to connect with Christian population

## NAGALAND

**ADVANTAGES**

● Relative peace in state ● Fewer areas under draconian AFSPA rule ● Development projects from Centre

**CHALLENGES**

● Sub-nationalism sentiments ● Rebellious CM Neiphiu Rio of the NDPP doesn't want to play ball with the party ● BJP still a minor player

## MIZORAM

**ADVANTAGES**

● PM Modi's pro-development approach ● BJP won 12 of the 25 seats in Mara Autonomous District Council (MADC) polls

**CHALLENGES**

● Ally Zoramthanga of the Mizo National Front not keen on a poll tie-up ● Majority Christian population still wary of BJP

## TRIPURA

**ADVANTAGES**

● Cross-country connectivity through Bangladesh ● Development projects executed ● Anti-Left sentiment

**CHALLENGES**

● Factionalism in state unit ● TMC building up base in state ● New CM Manik Saha has little time to fight anti-incumbency

*Graphic by* ASIT ROY

■ BJP-ruled states ■ Oppn-ruled states ■ President's Rule